

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-I.3: First and Second Declension Nouns

Produce and parse first- and second-declension nouns, including neuters and vocatives, in connected phrases

A self-contained learning packet with a local reference card, enriched submodules, selected handwritten practice, a mastery record, and matching answers. This working study is not an official liturgical book or approved curriculum.

Corpus	1962 <i>Missale Romanum</i> ; Vulgate and ecclesiastical prose as supporting readers
Method	Print, annotate, parse, copy, transform, translate, and compose by hand
Pacing	Advance by demonstrated mastery; module packets use two focused sessions as a planning envelope
Document	Learning module; learner and terminal-key edition
Triptych: AI Driven Studies in Catholic Faith, Worship, and Law	

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Part I

Module Plan and Reference

CHAPTER 1

Plan, prerequisites, and advancement decision

Module ID	EL-I.3
Course stage	Stage I — Foundations
Prerequisites	EL-I.2 mastery: justify case, number, gender, agreement, and government
Observable outcome	Produce and parse first- and second-declension nouns, including neuters and vocatives, in connected phrases
Printed practice	Worksheets I.9 (guided Variant A) and I.12 (independent Variant D), with terminal keys
Extension bank	Worksheets I.10 and I.11 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants
Next dependency	EL-I.4, The Third Declension

1.1 Two focused sessions

Session 1 — guided acquisition. Learn the exact first- and second-declension paradigms and neuter and vocative rules, then complete Worksheet I.9 as the guided application.

Session 2 — transfer and gate. Retrieve a high-frequency Missal noun mini-lexicon, resolve overlapping endings by syntax, complete Worksheet I.12 independently, and correct every noun by stem and ending.

The two-session plan is a workload envelope, not permission to advance by elapsed time. Stop, correct in a different color, and use an omitted variant when the mastery evidence below is absent.

Advance when: Write at least 34 of the 36 displayed forms correctly, justify at least eight of ten ambiguous first- or second-declension forms by syntax, and read an unseen two-clause sample without treating a neuter plural as singular.

CHAPTER 2

Module reference card

2.1 Terms, forms, and decisions to retrieve

- first-declension and masculine and neuter second-declension paradigms;
- the neuter nominative–accusative identity and plural *-a*;
- second-declension vocatives, including ordinary *-e* and relevant *-i* forms; and
- stem-plus-ending analysis when *-æ*, *-o*, *-is*, or a neuter form overlaps.

2.2 High-risk contrast

A declension class is identified from the dictionary nominative and genitive, not from one isolated surface ending. Neuter nominative and accusative forms coincide, but their clause functions remain distinct.

2.3 Working protocol

Before looking anything up, mark the finite verb or verbal center, propose dictionary forms, and record at least two formally possible readings where an ending is syncretic. Use the identified 1962 Missal and the course source record for received wording. A familiar English rendering does not replace a parse.

Part II

Core Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Unit 3: First and Second Declension Nouns

On completing this unit, you can:

- decline a regular first-declension noun and masculine and neuter second-declension nouns;
- apply the neuter nominative–accusative rule and form vocatives;
- identify case from ending plus syntax when endings overlap; and
- read first- and second-declension forms in Mass and biblical phrases.

1.1 Exact paradigms

The **declension** is the noun’s pattern of case endings. First-declension genitive singular ends in *-æ*; second-declension genitive singular in *-i*. A **paradigm** is an ordered display of every form in such a pattern; each cell represents a particular case and number. Learn forms vertically and horizontally.

	<i>missa, -æ f.</i>		<i>dominus, -i m.</i>		<i>verbum, -i n.</i>	
	sg.	pl.	sg.	pl.	sg.	pl.
Nom.	missa	missæ	dominus	domini	verbum	verba
Gen.	missæ	missarum	domini	dominorum	verbi	verborum
Dat.	missæ	missis	domino	dominis	verbo	verbis
Acc.	missam	missas	dominum	dominos	verbum	verba
Abl.	missa	missis	domino	dominis	verbo	verbis
Voc.	missa	missæ	domine	domini	verbum	verba

In every neuter noun, nominative and accusative are identical; their plural ends in *-a*. A regular masculine noun in *-us* has vocative singular *-e*: *dominus* → *Domine*. Nouns in *-ius* normally have vocative *-i*, as *filius* → *fili*. *Deus* has liturgical and classical irregularities; learn its attested forms in phrases rather than forcing every slot into the regular *dominus* pattern.

Biblical and liturgical Latin regularly uses masculine plural *cæli*, *cælorum* alongside neuter singular *cælum*, *cæli*, rather than the regular neuter plural *cæla*. This explains masculine plural *pleni* in *pleni sunt cæli et terra*; record the singular and liturgical plural behavior together in the lexicon.

Worked example: *In principio creavit Deus cælum et terram* (Gn 1:1)

Worked passage ID: W.I.8; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

in with ablative *principio* means “in the beginning”. *creavit* is the finite verb, “created”. *Deus* is nominative singular subject. *cælum* is accusative singular neuter and *terram* accusative singular feminine; they are coordinated direct objects. Translation: “In the beginning God created heaven and earth.” The ending and syntax distinguish accusative *cælum* from the identical nominative form.

Worked example: *Per omnia sæcula sæculorum*

Worked passage ID: W.I.9; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

per governs accusative. *omnia* is accusative plural neuter and agrees with *sæcula*, accusative plural neuter. *sæculorum* is genitive plural, “of ages”. Literal translation: “through all ages of ages”; idiomatically, “for ever and ever”.

Worked example: *Deo gratias*

Worked passage ID: W.I.10; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

The second-declension ending *-o* could be dative or ablative singular. Here the implied act of giving thanks needs a recipient, so *Deo* is dative, not ablative. *gratias* is first-declension accusative plural. Translation: “Thanks be to God.”

Worked example: *Peccata mundi*

Worked passage ID: W.I.11; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

peccata is nominative or accusative plural neuter of *peccatum*; the clause decides which. *mundi* is genitive singular of *mundus*, “of the world”. In *qui tollis peccata mundi*, the verb *tollis* makes *peccata* its accusative object: “the sins of the world”.

1.2 Handwritten study and controlled composition

Write each paradigm once while looking, once from memory, and once in the order accusative–nominative–genitive–dative–ablative–vocative. Circle every ending shared by more than one case. Parse all nouns in Genesis 1:1 above. Then compose *Dominus amat Ecclesiam*, “the Lord loves the Church”; change subject and object to plural, *Domini amant Ecclesias*; and make direct address plus command, *Domine, ama Ecclesiam*. The last verb is supplied as a model; the noun changes remain the assessed work.

Advance when: Write all 36 displayed noun forms with at least 34 correct, parse ten ambiguous *-æ*, *-o*, *-is*, or neuter forms with at least eight functions justified, and translate an unseen two-clause passage without treating a neuter plural as singular.

Part III

Enrichment by Submodule

CHAPTER 1

Connections, transfer, and retrieval

1.1 Exact paradigms — enrichment and transfer

Connection. A small high-frequency mini-lexicon links complete dictionary entries to the forms actually encountered in the Missal.

Transfer task. Build a six-entry card from lesson nouns: two first-declension, two masculine second-declension, and two neuter second-declension entries. For each, write nominative, genitive, gender, stem, and one liturgically frequent oblique form already used in the lesson.

Retrieval check. Cover the card and state the neuter rule and the information supplied by a noun's genitive singular.

1.2 Handwritten study and controlled composition — enrichment and transfer

Connection. Changing number or clause role tests a whole paradigm more effectively than reciting endings in a fixed order.

Transfer task. Apply the lesson's singular-to-plural and statement-to-address transformations. Underline the stem once and box the ending in every changed noun.

Retrieval check. Explain why a vocative transformation changes *Dominus* but does not turn an object into a vocative.

Part IV

Selected Practice

CHAPTER 1

Unit 3: First and Second Declensions

Unit 3: First and Second Declensions — Variant A**Worksheet ID:** I.9**Focus:** Paradigms, neuters, vocatives, and liturgical noun phrases**Use:** Write full forms, not ending fragments.

1. Give these forms of *missa*, *missæ* f.: genitive singular, dative plural, accusative plural, ablative singular.

-
2. Give these forms of *dominus*, *domini* m.: vocative singular, accusative singular, nominative plural, genitive plural.

-
3. Apply the neuter rule to *verbum*, *verbi* n.: give nominative/accusative singular and nominative/accusative plural.

-
4. Transform *Dominus servum vocat* so that plural lords call plural servants; label both noun cases.

-
5. Translate and parse the noun phrase *per omnia sæcula sæculorum*.

-
6. **Text:** *In principio creavit Deus cælum et terram.*

Passage ID: I.9.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse each noun and translate.

Definition/error check: First define uncertain Focus terms from memory; after the work, record each correction's rule.

Unit 3: First and Second Declensions — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** I.12**Focus:** Paradigm recall, neuter control, and syntax**Use:** This may replace any other Unit 3 variant.

1. Write the full plural paradigm of *missa*, *missæ* *f.* in case order.
-

2. Write the full singular paradigm of *verbum*, *verbi* *n.* in case order.
-

3. Give the requested form: “of God”; “O Lord”; “to the son”; “with gifts”; “the churches” as direct object.
-

4. Explain why *dona* in *dona nobis pacem* and *dona Dei* should not receive the same analysis.
-

5. Correct *Filius custodit ecclesia Domini*, intended “The Son guards the Church of the Lord”.
-

6. **Text:** *Peccata mundi tollis*.

Passage ID: I.12.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

This is a controlled transformation of *qui tollis peccata mundi*, not a received quotation; apply the neuter rule and parse the genitive.

Definition/error check: First define uncertain Focus terms from memory; after the work, record each correction’s rule.

Part V**Mastery Decision****CHAPTER 1**

Mastery and error record

Complete this page before opening the answer part.

Evidence	Session 1	Session 2 / delayed check
Date and elapsed focused time		
Worksheet ID and score		
One rule retrieved without notes		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or delayed item used		

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:**

Reason in one complete sentence:

Part VI

Answer Key

CHAPTER 1

How to Use the Keys

These keys diagnose grammatical decisions. Compare them only after completing the corresponding worksheet or assessment in ink. For a closed item, locate the form, function, government, or clause relation that decides the answer; a matching English paraphrase alone is not enough. For an open task, use the stated model and rubric to test morphology, syntax, idiom, and source control.

Some translations legitimately admit more than one English wording. An alternative is acceptable when it preserves the Latin agency, negation, time, dependency, and material ambiguity. Record a defensible alternative in the error ledger rather than changing it merely to imitate the model's style.

CHAPTER 2

Enrichment models and rubrics

Exact paradigms — model and rubric

Connection. A small high-frequency mini-lexicon links complete dictionary entries to the forms actually encountered in the Missal.

Model / acceptable evidence. A correct card preserves each lesson dictionary entry, derives the stem from the genitive, and labels the selected oblique form accurately. The retrieval statement must say that neuter nominative and accusative are identical and that neuter plurals end in *-a*; the genitive identifies the stem and declensional pattern.

Handwritten study and controlled composition — model and rubric

Connection. Changing number or clause role tests a whole paradigm more effectively than reciting endings in a fixed order.

Model / acceptable evidence. The transformed forms must preserve their intended clause roles and use the correct number. A sound explanation distinguishes morphological vocative marking from syntactic role: only the person addressed becomes vocative; an object remains accusative even when another noun changes to direct address.

CHAPTER 3

Selected worksheet solutions

CHAPTER 4

Unit 3: First and Second Declensions

Unit 3: First and Second Declensions — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.9

Focus: Paradigms, neuters, vocatives, and liturgical noun phrases

Use: Write full forms, not ending fragments.

1. Give these forms of *missa*, *missæ* f.: genitive singular, dative plural, accusative plural, ablative singular.
Answer / model: *missæ*, *missis*, *missas*, *missa*.
2. Give these forms of *dominus*, *domini* m.: vocative singular, accusative singular, nominative plural, genitive plural.
Answer / model: *domine*, *dominum*, *domini*, *dominorum*.
3. Apply the neuter rule to *verbum*, *verbi* n.: give nominative/accusative singular and nominative/accusative plural.
Answer / model: Singular nominative and accusative: *verbum*; plural nominative and accusative: *verba*.
4. Transform *Dominus servum vocat* so that plural lords call plural servants; label both noun cases.
Answer / model: *Domini servos vocant*. *Domini* is nominative plural; *servos* is accusative plural.
5. Translate and parse the noun phrase *per omnia sæcula sæculorum*.
Answer / model: “through all ages of ages” or idiomatically “forever and ever”. *per* governs neuter plural accusative *omnia sæcula*; *sæculorum* is neuter plural genitive.
6. **Text:** *In principio creavit Deus cælum et terram*.
Passage ID: I.9.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Parse each noun and translate.
Answer / notes: *principio*: neuter singular ablative after *in*; *Deus*: masculine singular nominative subject; *cælum*: neuter singular accusative object; *terram*: feminine singular accusative coordinated object. “In the beginning God created heaven and earth.”

Unit 3: First and Second Declensions — Variant D

Worksheet ID: I.12

Focus: Paradigm recall, neuter control, and syntax

Use: This may replace any other Unit 3 variant.

1. Write the full plural paradigm of *missa*, *missæ* f. in case order.
Answer / model: *missæ*, *missarum*, *missis*, *missas*, *missis*, *missæ*.
2. Write the full singular paradigm of *verbum*, *verbi* n. in case order.
Answer / model: *verbum*, *verbi*, *verbo*, *verbum*, *verbo*, *verbum*.
3. Give the requested form: “of God”; “O Lord”; “to the son”; “with gifts”; “the churches” as direct object.
Answer / model: *Dei*; *Domine*; *filio*; *cum donis*; *ecclesias*.
4. Explain why *dona* in *dona nobis pacem* and *dona Dei* should not receive the same analysis.
Answer / model: In *dona nobis*, *dona* is the singular imperative “grant”. In *dona Dei*, it is neuter plural nominative or accusative noun “gifts”, modified by genitive *Dei*. Syntax and dictionary possibilities decide.
5. Correct *Filius custodit ecclesia Domini*, intended “The Son guards the Church of the Lord”.
Answer / model: *Filius custodit Ecclesiam Domini*. Direct object *Ecclesiam* must be accusative; *Domini* is correctly genitive.
6. **Text:** *Peccata mundi tollis*.
Passage ID: I.12.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
This is a controlled transformation of *qui tollis peccata mundi*, not a received quotation; apply the neuter rule and parse the genitive.
Answer / notes: *peccata*: neuter plural accusative object; neuter plural nominative would look identical, but second-person verb and context make it object. *mundi*: masculine singular genitive. Understood subject: *tu*. “You take away the sins of the world.”

Part VII

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-I.3, *First and Second Declension Nouns*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative teaching unit, its local reference decisions, enrichment for each internal submodule, the selected worksheets named in the module plan, and the matching solutions. This packet covers the first two noun declensions and their frequent liturgical uses, not the complete noun system.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. Two focused sessions describe the packet's planned core, while the mastery gate and delayed recall determine advancement.

1.2 Corpus, text, and limits

The controlling reader is the 1962 typical edition of the *Missale Romanum*; the identified Clementine Vulgate and other ecclesiastical prose are supporting corpora. Running Latin normally uses consonantal *i*, the ligature *æ*, and no macrons. Received excerpts may normalize typography but are not diplomatic transcriptions unless labeled. Uncited short drills, transformations, and instructional models are project-composed; English translations and glosses are project translations unless identified otherwise.

This packet teaches language competence. It is not an official liturgical book, approved seminary curriculum, certification, pronunciation or ceremonial course, critical edition, or authority for a liturgical, theological, textual, or canonical judgment. Check received wording against the editions identified in the course-wide passage inventory.

1.3 Review, rights, and release state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and enrichment. No independent Latinist, liturgist, pedagogue, theologian, or ecclesiastical reviewer is claimed. Page-image collation and the donor and liturgical-text distribution bases remain unresolved pre-installation gates. The packet therefore remains a working build on hold, not an installed or released publication.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.
- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-20T21:32:44Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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